

Unilever -

Wednesday, 3 June 2026

05:57

Sources for use with Section A

Extract A

Unilever's purpose and Growth Action Plan

Unilever is a British multinational consumer goods company. It owns around 400 brands and sells food, home care, personal care and beauty products to consumers in more than 190 countries. Its best-known brands include Dove, Knorr, Hellmann's, Domestos, Magnum and Sunsilk. In 2024 Unilever employed approximately 128,000 people worldwide.

In 2024, under Chief Executive Officer Hein Schumacher, Unilever launched a new corporate purpose: "To brighten everyday life for all." The company says this purpose is at the heart of a new strategy, the Growth Action Plan 2030, which is built on three clear priorities:

- delivering higher-quality, faster growth by focusing investment on 30 'Power Brands' that generate over 75% of turnover
- creating a simpler, more productive business by reducing costs and removing complexity
- building a strong performance culture so that decisions are made faster and held to account.

Schumacher summarised the approach as a commitment to "do fewer things, better, and with greater impact." As part of the plan, Unilever announced it would separate its Ice Cream division into a standalone business and carry out a major productivity programme.

Extract B

Selected financial data for Unilever, 2023 and 2024

	2023 (€bn)	2024 (€bn)
Turnover (revenue)	59.60	60.80
Cost of sales	(33.36)	(33.44)
Operating profit	9.90	9.40
Profit for the year	6.40	6.37
Total equity	20.80	22.60
Non-current liabilities	28.60	28.20

Note: figures are rounded and presented for the purpose of this paper.

Extract C

Setting objectives for growth

To turn its purpose into action, Unilever set itself measurable corporate objectives. These included delivering underlying sales growth of between 3% and 5% each year, with a rising share coming from higher sales volumes rather than price rises; growing underlying operating margin; and achieving a return on invested capital in the "high teens". The company also set targets to reduce greenhouse gas emissions in its own operations and to support millions of small businesses through its digital platforms.

In 2024 Unilever reported underlying sales growth of 4.2%, with its 30 Power Brands growing faster than the rest of the business at 5.3%. Unilever stated that clear, shared objectives helped its five Business Groups to "pull in the same direction".

Extract D

Underlying sales growth (USG) by Business Group

Business Group	2023 USG	2024 USG
Beauty & Wellbeing	8.3%	6.5%
Personal Care	8.5%	5.2%
Home Care	5.9%	2.9%
Foods	8.9%	2.6%
Ice Cream	5.3%	3.7%

Unilever Group (total)	7.0%	4.2%
------------------------	------	------

Note: underlying sales growth (USG) measures the growth in sales excluding the effects of currency changes and businesses bought or sold.

SECTION A

Read Extracts A, B, C and D in the Source Booklet before answering Question 1.

Write your answers in the spaces provided.

1 (a) Using Extract B, calculate to two decimal places, the net profit margin for Unilever in 2024. You are advised to show your working. **(4)**

(b) Explain one benefit to Unilever of developing its corporate objectives from its corporate purpose (mission). **(4)**

Unilever has replaced its previous purpose with a new corporate purpose: "To brighten everyday life for all."

(c) Discuss whether Unilever's corporate purpose meets the characteristics of an effective mission statement. **(8)**